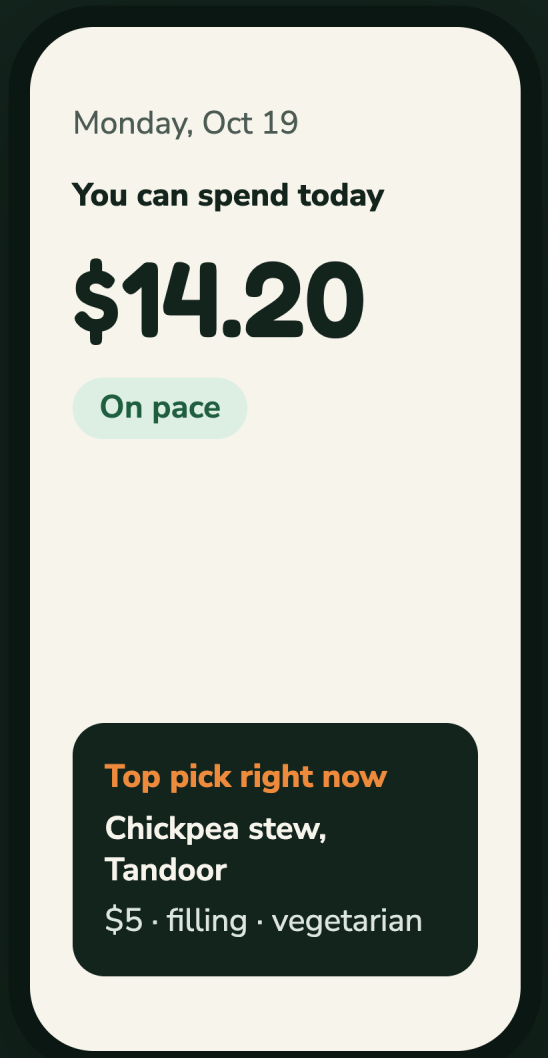
A DUKE DINING APP

Pace

Eat well, stay full, and never run out of food points.



THE PROBLEM

Food points disappear quietly

A balance means nothing

Seeing your total doesn't tell you what you can spend on lunch today. So most people ignore it until it's almost gone.

Same food, different price

Chickpea stew is about $5 at Tandoor and $12 at Farmstead. Nobody compares, so everyone overpays.

Nutrition is buried

The numbers exist online, but nobody checks before ordering. One café crepe was found to have 84g of sugar.

Sources: student observation (stew prices); The Chronicle on Duke NetNutrition, 2020 (crepe)

THE INSIGHT

Students don’t need another calorie counter. They need to know what they can afford today, and the best food for it.

WHAT WE FOUND

148 prices, checked by hand across campus

$1.99 vs $3

The same Bubbl'r can at the Lobby Shop vs every vending machine on campus.

Same

Vending prices match across buildings. The real gaps are vending vs shops and cafés.

It flips

Clif Bar is cheaper at the Lobby Shop. Barebells and Poppi are cheaper in vending.

Student price checks, Oct–Nov 2026: 9 locations including the Lobby Shop, West Union, Bryan Center and Trinity vending.

HOW IT WORKS

Three steps, five seconds a week

1

Enter your balance

Type it in once a week. No logins, no tracking every snack.

2

Get your daily pace

One number: what you can spend today and still last the semester.

3

Eat the best you can afford

See the most filling, nutritious picks within today's budget, at places open now.

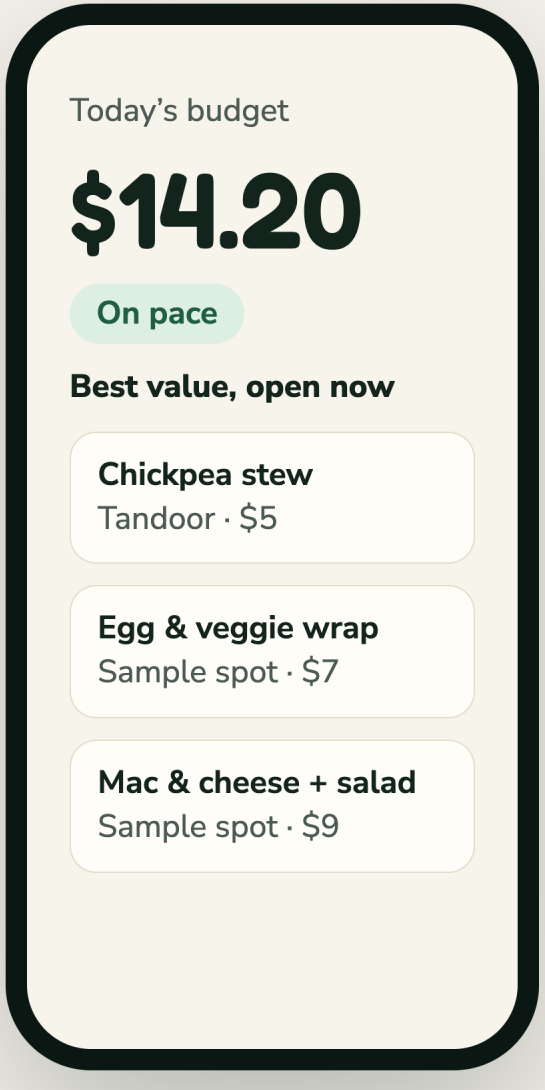
SCREEN 1 · TODAY

One number, every day

Your balance becomes a daily budget that updates after every meal.

Picks are ranked by value: how filling and nutritious they are for the price, at places open right now.

Sample screen. Items and prices are illustrative.



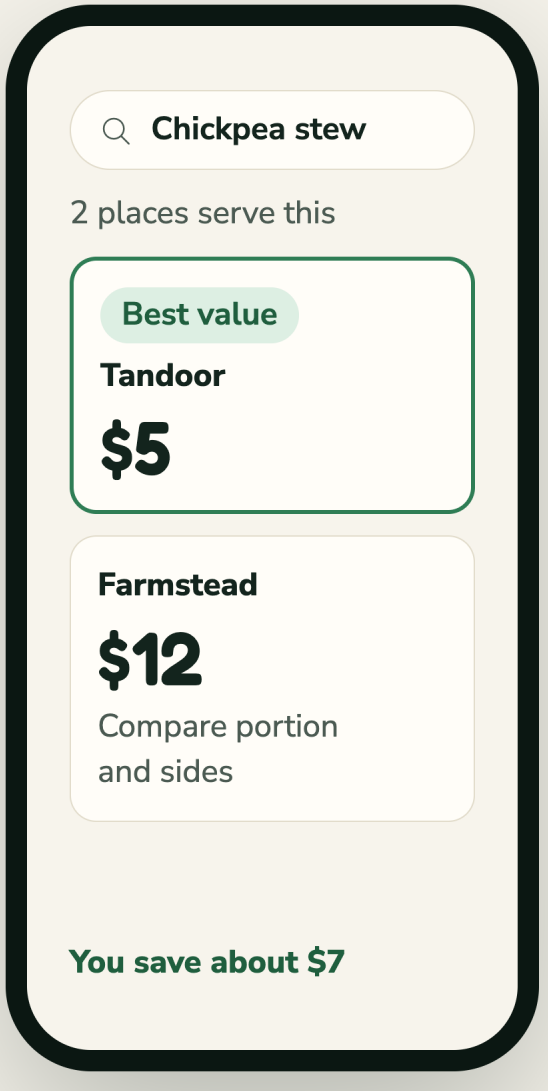
SCREEN 2 · COMPARE

Same craving, better deal

Similar food is priced very differently across campus. Pace shows where your craving costs the least.

It compares portions and sides too, so “cheaper” is always a fair comparison for every vendor.

Sample screen. Items and prices are illustrative.



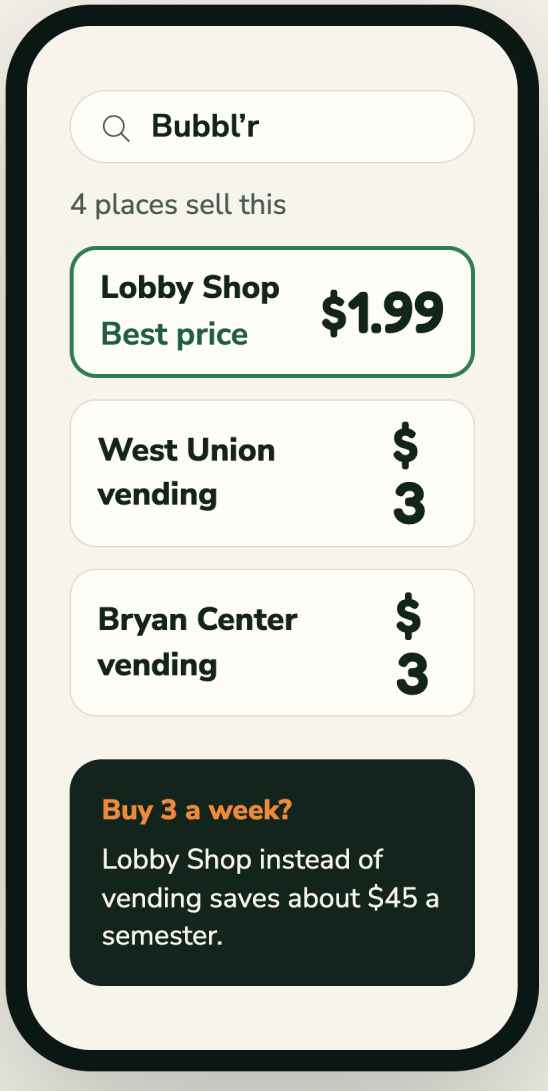
SCREEN 3 · SNACKS

The exact same can, two prices

Packaged snacks and drinks are identical everywhere, so the cheapest spot always wins. Pace tells you where it is.

Small gaps add up: a dollar on your usual drink becomes real money by the end of the semester.

Real prices from student checks, Nov 2026.



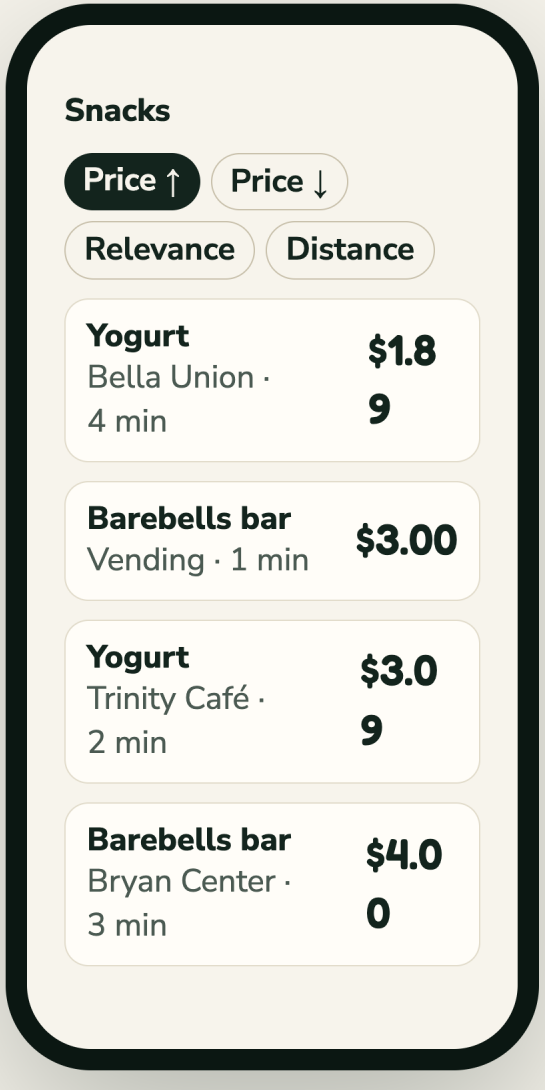
SCREEN 4 · BROWSE

Sort it your way

Browse every snack on campus and sort by price low to high, high to low, relevance or distance.

Cheapest overall, or cheapest within a two-minute walk. Students pick what matters right now.

Sample screen. Distances are illustrative.



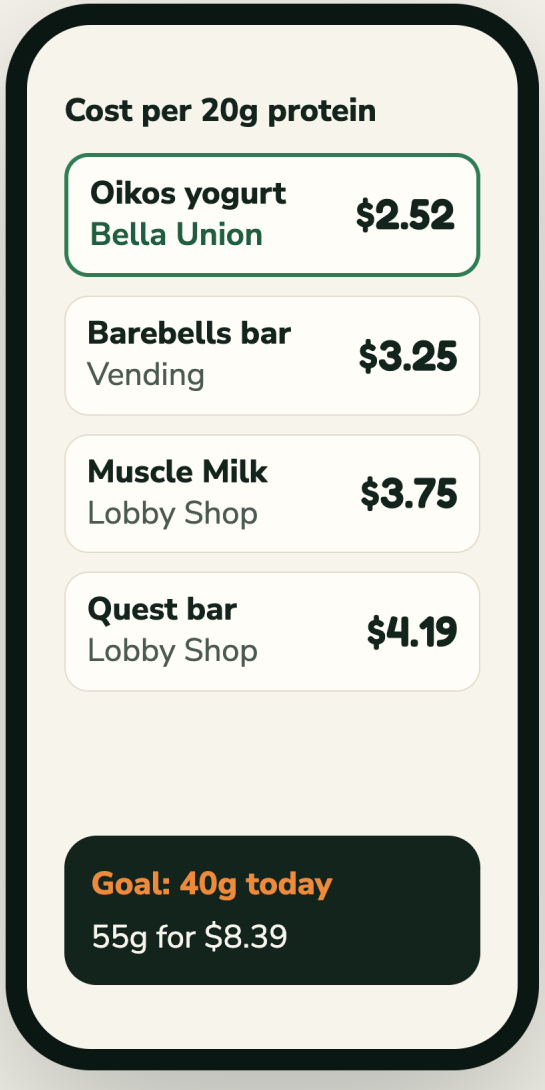
SCREEN 5 · PROTEIN

The most protein for your points

Every protein snack ranked by what 20 grams of protein really costs, at the cheapest spot on campus.

Set a goal and Pace builds the cheapest way to hit it, like 55g for $8.39.

Real prices; protein from typical package labels.



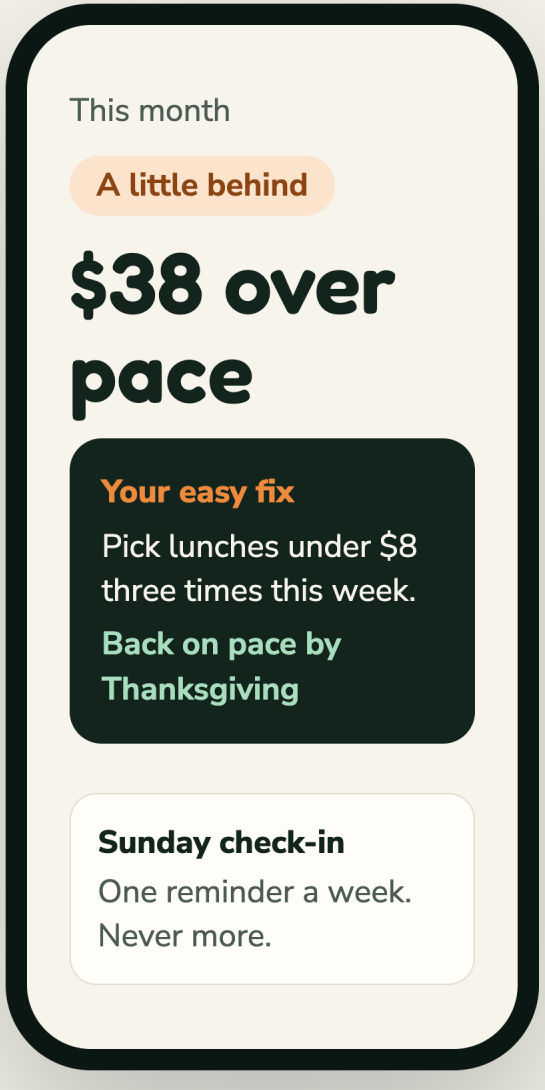
SCREEN 6 · BACK ON TRACK

A plan, not a guilt trip

Most students already know they’re off track. Pace gives them one small, specific fix.

Ahead of pace? It says that too, so leftover points don’t go to waste.

Sample screen. Numbers are illustrative.



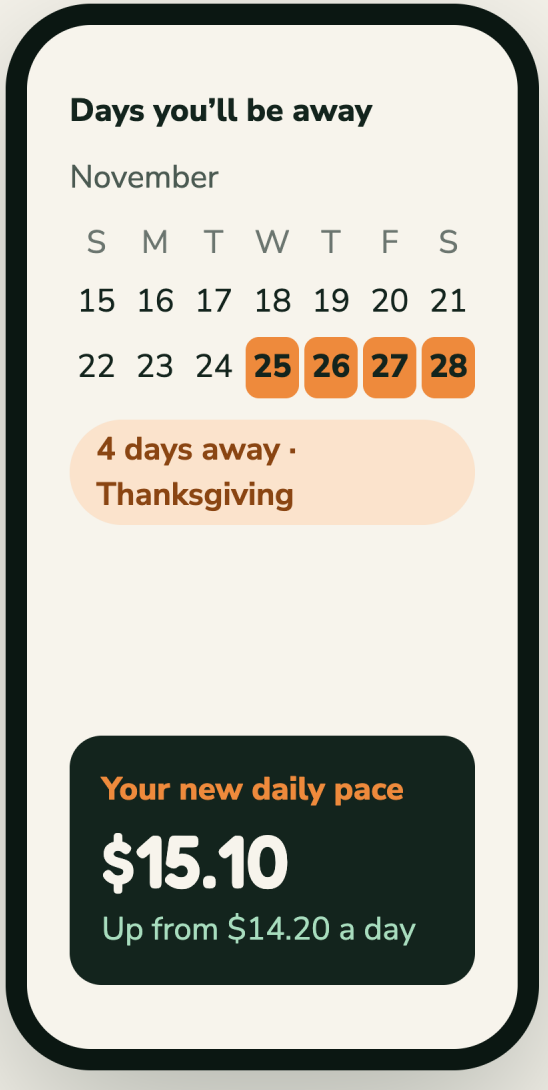
SCREEN 7 · AWAY DAYS

Not on campus? Don’t budget for it

Tap the days you’ll be gone, like breaks, trips or weekends home. Pace spreads your points over the days you’re actually here.

Duke’s breaks can come preloaded, so most students never have to set this up.

Sample screen. Numbers are illustrative.



THE LANDSCAPE

Others do one piece. Pace connects them.

	Food Points Calculator	Munchr	Blue Dine	Pace
What it is	Student points calculator	Student vending map	Hackathon project	Our app
Cheapest spot	No	No	No	Yes
Item prices	No	Not listed	Yes	Yes
Tips to stay on track	Daily target only	No	Budget goals	Yes
Protein per dollar	No	No	No	Yes
Food points pace	Yes	No	Basic budget	Yes
Nutrition info	No	No	Partial	Yes

Based on public pages: dukefoodpoints.com, munchr.app and Blue Dine (Devpost).

ROADMAP

Live now, then make the data easy

NOW

Pace is live

148 prices: deals, protein value, daily pace, my usuals.

NEXT

Pace Scanner

Snap a shelf or vending photo. Prices fill in by themselves.

THEN

Crowd prices

Students report prices, so the data stays fresh without us.

LATER

Partnership

Bring users to Duke Dining and DukeCard for official data.

NEXT STEP

20 students, two weeks

The goal

[__] students checking their pace every week.

The ask

An intro to Duke Dining and the DukeCard office.

Your feedback

What would make you open this every day?

Pace · eat well, stay full, keep your points